murderer was caught and confessed to killing her for her liberal views, it had been perceived as a warning sign for many young people in this study. There were students in Karachi who had gone to a protest condemning the murder of Sabeen Mahmud, but as one participant commented '*it was a tough decision to make*' since she was '*scared to go*'. Mahmud's murder was further connected to her openly celebrating Valentine's Day, which offended the religious sensibilities of her murderer. Such differences in opinion also reflect the kind of debates that religious versus leftist or nonreligious student unions have been engaged in on campuses. In Nelson's study of the University of Peshawar, violence erupted on campus following Valentine's Day because of the Jamiat's stance against Valentine's Day as being un-Islamic. Jamiat at the Punjab University has also engaged in violence against Valentine's Day, preventing couples from sitting together, to the point of beating up the men. The ideological battle for Pakistan, for what is permissible and what is 'haram' as defined by men still continues, and the violence it breeds clearly acts as a deterrent for young Pakistanis. '*I think the main problem in Pakistan is that people like us will not join politics, so nothing will change*' (Focus Group, Private University[42]). There have also been examples like Mashal Khan, a student who had been politically active, and had taken on the university administration for its corruption, but ended up being lynched by fellow students after false accusations of blasphemy were made against him (Akbar 2017). Further investigations exposed the university's connection with his murder. The freedom to be politically active, to even be taught about politics or civic values within schools and universities, is almost nonexistent today. While there have been exceptions of university professors attempting to create an atmosphere to promote political awareness and activism, such professors have been pushed out from universities.[43] There is an increasing call for universities to follow the state narrative on security, becoming part of the security agenda as evident in the seminar organized by the ISPR at the army auditorium entitled 'Role of Youth in Rejecting Extremism'. The ISPR has also been active in giving talks at universities about the challenges facing Pakistan, and inviting students to interact with soldiers. Talks on PTM or Baloch rights have been shut down not just in government universities, but also in elite private universities, either through warnings or through intimidation by the security state.

The nature of political activism across different generations in Pakistan has clearly changed, with young people less politically active than their parents' and, one could argue, their grandparents' generation. From the student activists involved in the Pakistan movement, to students who believe that politics and education are antithetical to each other, the present generation of students is